Context

Mid-market EU fashion retail, Western Europe, €1–5B revenue.

Fragmented 22-country stacks.

GDPR and ESPR compliance pressure.

Omnichannel promise outpacing operational capability.

Speaker note: Meridian sits in a segment under pressure from both ends — Inditex above, Shein below. The 22-country fragmentation isn't tech debt — it's blocking the business model.

Problem

Shoppers reserve click-and-collect orders, arrive at stores, find items unavailable.

Root cause: 22 country inventory systems do not share a live view of stock.

> ⚠ **Speaker note:** Zara's own site says availability is "tentative." For a benchmark player that's acceptable. For a mid-market retailer justifying store investment, it's a broken promise.

Opportunity

Real-time inventory availability prediction across all stores.

Replace tentative stock signals with a confidence-adjusted available-to-promise score per SKU.

Speaker note: The data already exists across 22 systems — it just isn't unified. We're not asking for new data collection; we're asking for an aggregation layer.

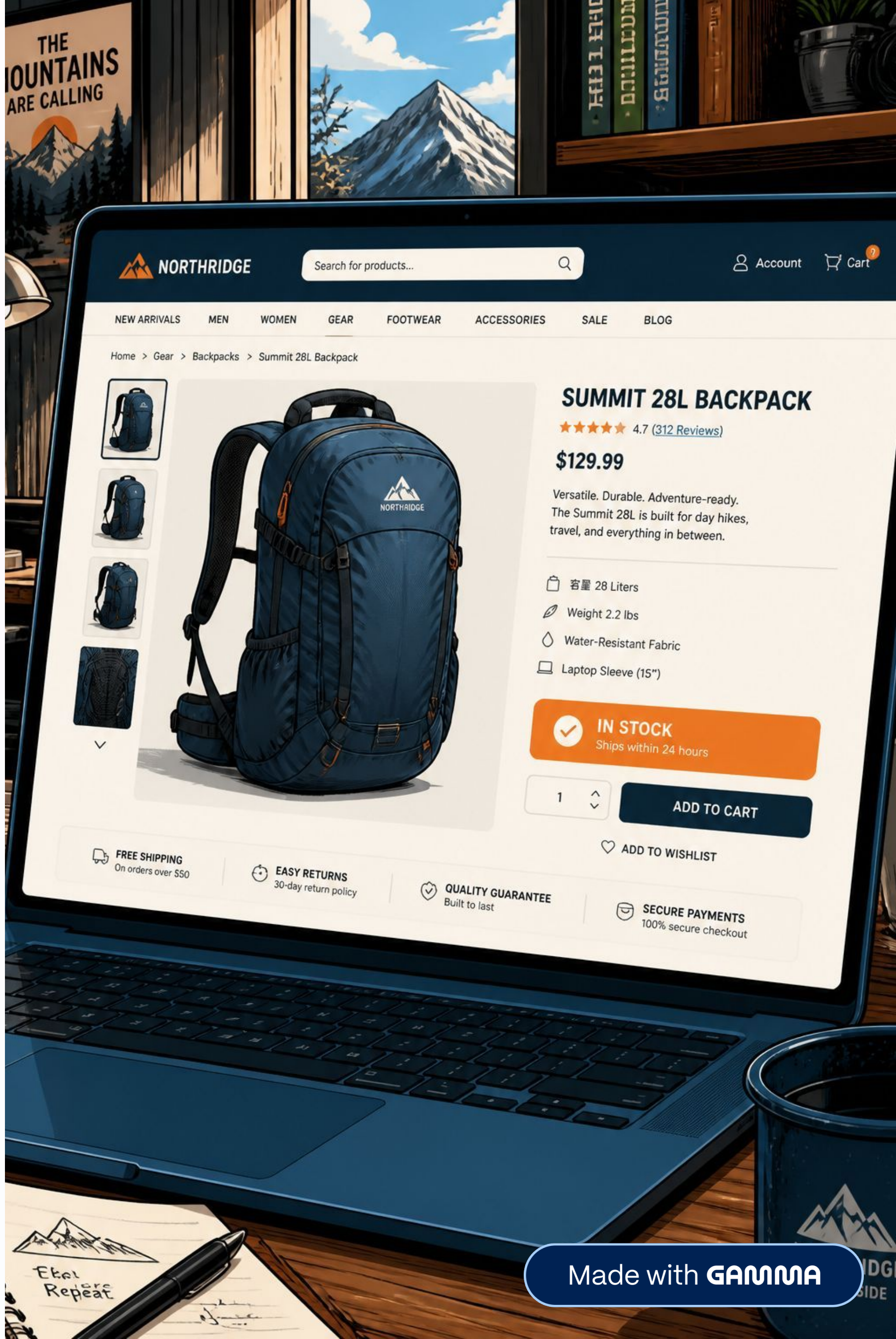
Solution

A live available-to-promise signal at the product page.

Confirmed availability, not tentative guesses.

Store staff alerted only when a confirmed order is at risk.

Speaker note: The back end is invisible to the shopper. What changes is the certainty of the promise on the product page.



Value

≥30%

Reduction in click-and-collect cancellations

15%

Sector baseline

Recovered

Order value

Protected

Repeat purchase rate

Benchmark: Inditex stores-plus-digital model

Speaker note: The 30% threshold needs validating against client OMS data — it's the weakest number in this case. We confirm it in the spike.

ROI

€6.2M

Annual value (base case)

€2.85M

One-time cost

6 months

Payback (base case)

51 months

Payback (pessimistic)

All baselines unverified — confirm with client OMS data.

⚠ **Speaker note:** The pessimistic case is honest — 51 months if integration overruns and adoption is partial. The base case is compelling but depends on the cancellation baseline.

Risks

Binding gate: cancellation rate baseline unverified.

If actual rate is 5%, annual value drops 60%.

Integration overrun risk on 22-system scope.

Speaker note: The architecture spike answers both risks in 4 weeks. That's what the ask buys — de-risked investment, not just a feasibility check.

Ask

3 stacks	4 weeks	2 engineers
Representative systems	Duration	Team size

Validate integration feasibility and confirm cancellation rate baseline from client OMS.

Speaker note: We're not asking for the full build budget. We're asking for 4 weeks to answer the question that decides everything.

Timeline

Month 1–2

Spike and baseline validation

Month 3–6

MVP on 3 stacks

Month 7–12

Rollout to 22 stacks

Month 13+

Optimisation

Speaker note: 12 months to full rollout assumes a clean integration. The pessimistic case assumed 18. The spike narrows that range.

Next steps

Decision

Approve architecture spike (est. €80K)

Owner

Head of Omnichannel

Deadline

TBD

Kickoff

Within 2 weeks of approval

Speaker note: One decision. Everything else flows from it. If the spike shows the baseline is wrong, we stop before spending €2.5M.